

A CHRISTIAN FANTASY RPG

The Widowed Throne

Player's Manual

A hundred years after the Horn of Anointing vanished,
the purple throne stands empty.

September 2026

CONTENTS

Contents

Welcome to the City 3

The screen and controls 5

Your party 6

The City 9

Exploring 10

Combat 12

Prayer and psalms 14

The spiritual war 16

Equipment 18

Bestiary 20

Counsel from the Abba 22

CHAPTER 1

Welcome to the City

The Widowed Throne is a text role-playing game about the faithful who stand in the breach. It is set in a fantasy of Byzantium, a hundred years after God's anointed line lost the crown.

On the night Emperor Andronikos the Proud set his own statue inside the Great Church, the Horn of Anointing vanished. Within a year the giant king Nebrodes broke the walls and marched the faithful into exile. Rebel powers of the heavens took the provinces, called themes, and the Nephilim came back to rule the passes.

Thirty years ago a remnant came home and rebuilt the Land Walls with a trowel in one hand and a spear in the other. Before he died, the saint Symeon left a promise: a son of the Shepherd will sit on the throne again, and the Horn will find him.

You lead a band of up to six of the Called, from the Tagma of the Horn and the other fellowships. You will fight monsters with sword and sling, but the deeper war concerns allegiance. A demon draws strength from human worship, and a giant from human fear. You win when you break both.

Who you are up against

- **The Concord of the Tower.** Nebrodes' human servants: scribes, bankers, soldiers and seers who dream of one empire, one tongue, one law. Most of them believe they are saving the world.
- **The Bowed.** People who sold themselves to a rebel archon on purpose. The deepest of them went through the Great Bowing and became the **Idol-born**, the monstrous lords of the Holds.
- **The Legion.** People overrun by spirits. Most never chose it, and the Called can set them free.
- **The Adversary.** He has no side of his own. He offers good things at the wrong time and by the wrong road.

Dark as the themes are, the dark has already lost its war at the cross, and it knows. The risen Christ walks the themes as the **Lion of Judah**, bearing the wounds of the Lamb. Nobody can summon him. He comes when he chooses.

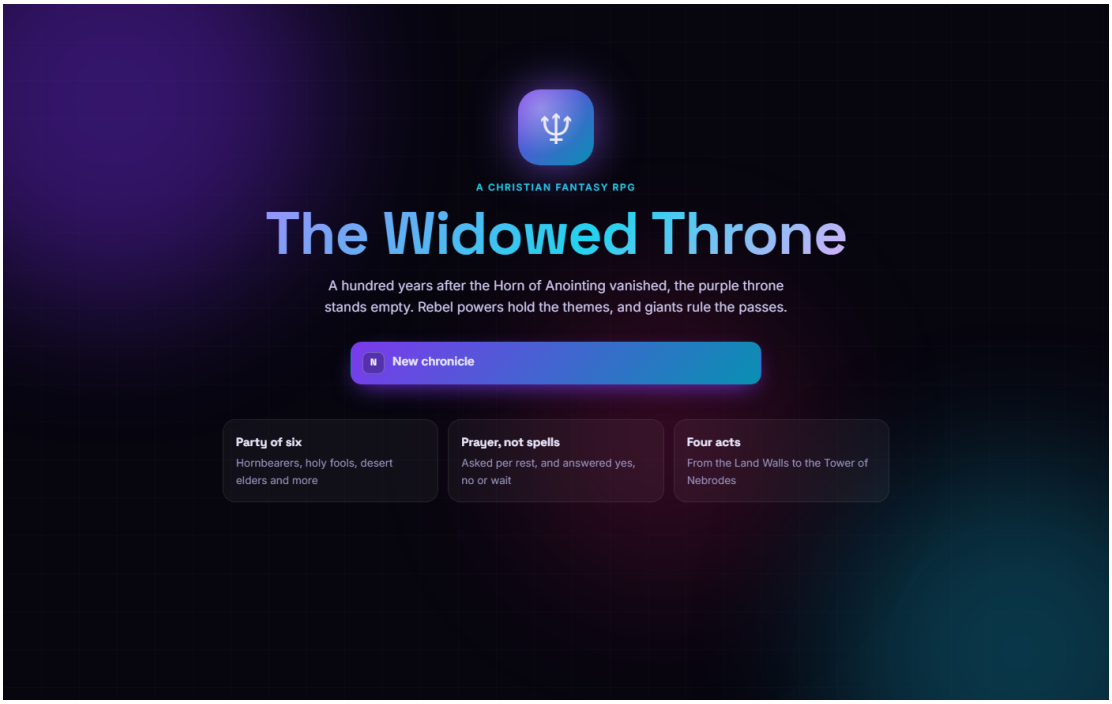
The four acts

Act	What happens
I · The Wall	Forged letters are turning the City's council against itself. Find who writes them in the Undercroft beneath the streets.
II · The Judges	Go to the ford named in a dead man's letter. Then sail into the four fallen themes, deliver each one's Hold, and find the four Words of Symeon.
III · The Tower	Nebrodes learns what you are doing. Strike at him in the Roots of his tower before his giant host reaches the walls.
IV · The Anointing	Descend beneath the Great Church to the Gate of Sheol, then face the question the whole chronicle has been asking.

Starting the game

Open **index.html** in any modern browser. Nothing needs installing. The game loads its fonts from the internet; offline, it uses your system fonts and still works.

Choose **New chronicle** on the title screen. You begin inside the Fool's Tower, where you gather your party. **Continue chronicle** picks up your last save. The game saves itself as you go.

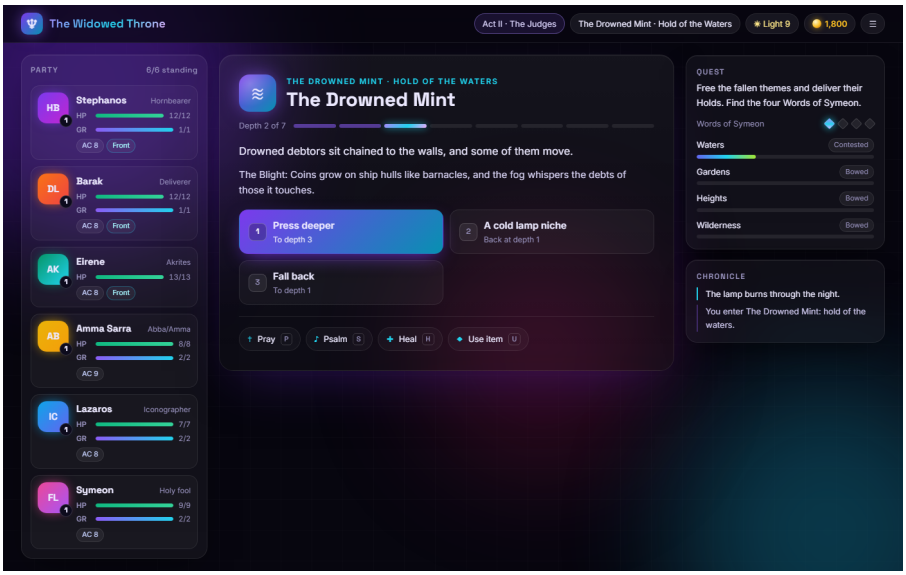


The title screen.

CHAPTER 2

The screen and controls

The screen has three columns. On a phone they stack, with the story on top.



Exploring the Drowned Mint. Party on the left, the story in the centre, the quest tracker and chronicle on the right.

Area	What it shows
Top bar	The current act, where you are, your light in dark places, your gold, and the menu button.
Party	A card for each member: hit points (HP), grace (GR, the prayers or special uses left), armour class, and tags such as Front, Poisoned or Fallen. The first three members are the front rank. Click a card while exploring to open the character sheet.
Story card	The scene, then your choices. Each choice is a button with its key on it. In a dungeon, a bar shows how deep you are.
Quest	Your current objective, the Words of Symeon you hold, and how far each theme has turned back to God.
Chronicle	A running record of what has happened, newest first.

Keys

Every choice shows its key, so you can play with the mouse, a touch screen or the keyboard.

Key	Action
1 to 9, letters	Pick the choice with that key.
Space or Enter	Continue.
Esc	Cancel or go back. While exploring, Esc opens the game menu.
P	Pray (while exploring).
S	Sing a psalm (holy fool).
H	Heal with hands (Anargyros).
U	Use an item from a pack.

The game menu lets you load your last save or start a new chronicle.

CHAPTER 3

Your party

Gather your band in the Fool's Tower. You can keep up to twelve characters on the roster and take six into the field.

Creating a character

- Choose a **people**. Each adjusts your starting scores.
- Roll your five scores. Keep them or roll again as often as you like.
- Choose a **calling**, your class.
- Type a name. The new member joins the party if there is room.

Quick band of six creates a ready party at once: Stephanos the Hornbearer, a Deliverer, an Akrites, an Amma of the Desert, a Painter of Light and a holy fool. Kosmas, one of the Anargyroi, waits on the roster in case you want a healer.

Scores

Each score is rolled on 2d6+4 and adjusted by your people, between 3 and 18. A score of 16 gives +1, 18 gives +2, and 5 or less gives -1.

Score	What it does
ST, Strength	Bonus to hit and to melee damage.
DX, Dexterity	Bonus to armour class, to shooting, and to acting early in a round.
CN, Constitution	Extra hit points when you start and each time you rise a level.
LK, Luck	Helps the party run away from a fight.
FA, Faith	At 16 or more, an extra prayer in circles 1 and 2.

Peoples

People	ST	DX	CN	LK	FA
Rhomaios	0	0	0	0	+1
Armenian	+1	0	+1	-1	0
Syrian	-1	+1	0	0	+1
Slav	+1	0	+1	0	-1
Isaurian	0	+1	+1	-1	0
Giant-blood	+3	-1	+2	-1	-2

Callings

Calling	Hit die	Weapons	Armour	Gift
Hornbearer	d10	All, including the kontarion lance	All	Armoured knight of the Tagma. Can rebuke a demon once per rest.
Akrites	d9	All but the kontarion	Up to mail and shield	Border warden of the Akritai. Critical hits, +4 damage to giants, avoids traps.
Deliverer	d10	All but the kontarion	All	An ordinary person God raises up. Once per rest the Spirit comes upon them.
Abba/Amma	d6	Club, staff, mace, sling, goad	Quilted coat, shield, helm	Elder of the Desert. Prayers of healing, protection and casting out.
Iconographer	d5	Dagger, staff, sling	Quilted coat	Painter of Light. Prayers of light, discernment, wards and passage.
Holy fool	d7	Club, dagger, staff, sling, goad	Up to mail, helm	Salos, a holy fool. Sings psalms. Immune to flattery, charm and temptation.
Anargyros	d7	Staff, club, sling, dagger	Quilted coat, helm	One of the Anargyroi, who heal without silver. Heals with the laying on of hands.

The gifts in detail

- **Hornbearer.** Strikes demons and giants at +2. **Rebuke** once per rest (twice from level 6): 3d6 plus level to every demon or shade in a group.
- **Akrites.** A chance of a mortal blow that slays any ordinary foe outright, 3% per level up to 30%. +4 damage to giants. Spots traps half the time, plus 5% per level.
- **Deliverer. Spirit of might** once per rest (twice from level 7): three attacks in one round, each with +4 damage.
- **Abba or Amma.** Prays the elder's prayers: healing, protection and casting out.
- **Iconographer.** A Painter of Light. Prays the icon painter's prayers: light, discernment, wards and passage.
- **Holy fool.** Sings psalms: 2 per rest, plus 1 for every three levels. Immune to charm and flattery, and never gains a foothold.
- **Anargyros. Healing hands** 2 plus level times per rest: heals 1d8 plus level and cures poison. Asks no payment.

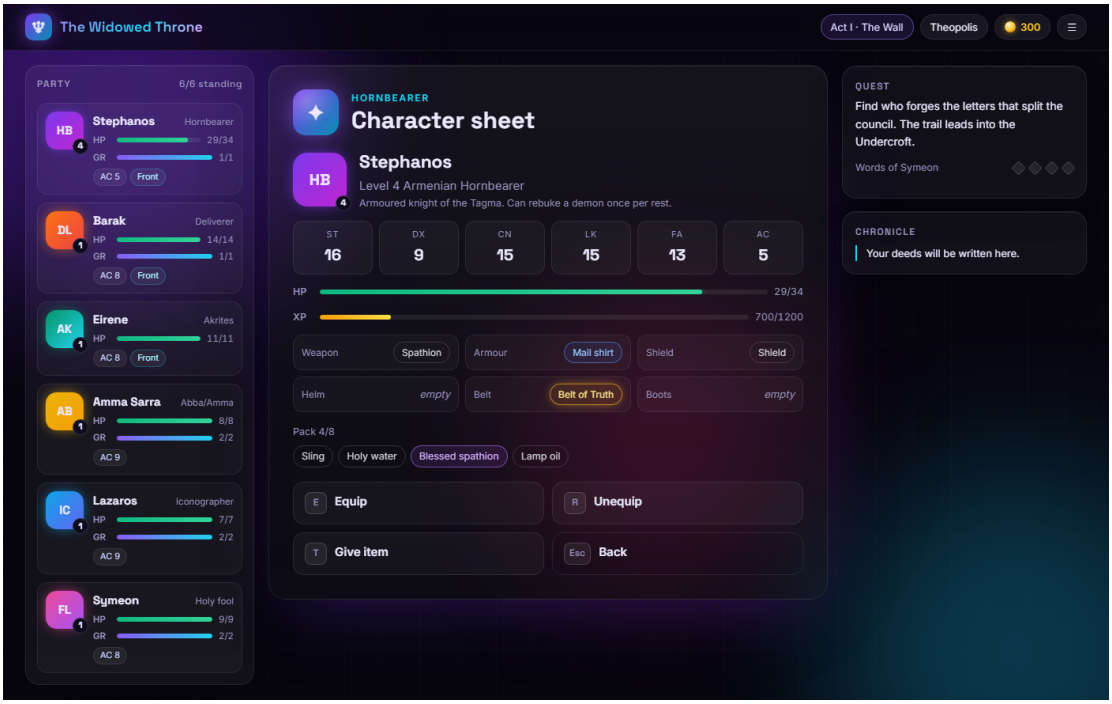
Hornbearers, Akrites and Deliverers gain an extra attack every six levels and +1 damage every three levels.

Levels and experience

Every foe you defeat gives experience, shared among the members still standing. When a member has enough, visit **Abba Pelagios** in the Fool's Tower. He raises them a level: new hit points from their hit die, and sometimes +1 to a score.

Level	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
XP needed	100	280	600	1,200	2,200	3,600	5,500

Level	9	10	11	12	13	14
XP needed	8,000	11,500	16,000	22,000	30,000	40,000



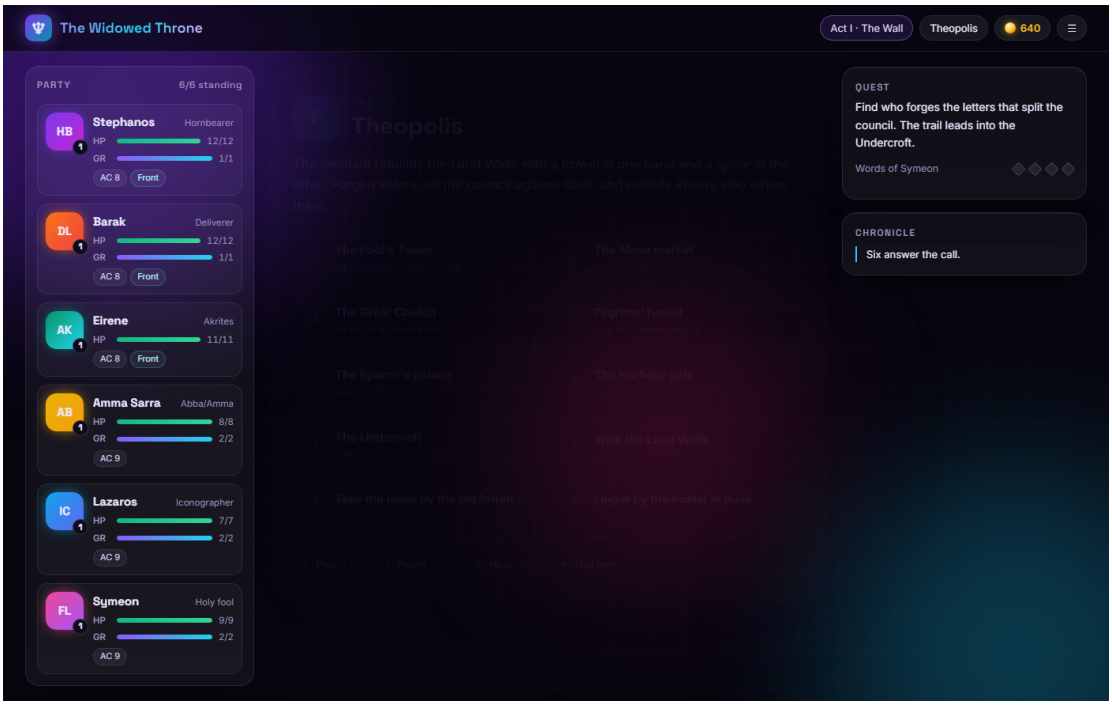
The character sheet. Items are coloured by rarity: blue is rare, purple is blessed, gold is the armour of God.

From the character sheet you can equip, unequip, or give an item to another member. Each pack holds eight items.

CHAPTER 4

The City

Theopolis is your home base. Choose a place to go.



Theopolis. Each place is a choice.

Place	What you can do
The Fool's Tower	Create, add, remove and order members. See the Abba to rise in level and hear counsel. Save.
The Mese market	Buy weapons, armour and supplies. Sell for half price. The armour of God and quest items cannot be sold.
The Great Church	Heal wounds (1 gold per hit point). Raise the dead (150 gold per level). Cure poison (20 gold). Confession. Later in the story, the way down into the deep Undercroft.
Pilgrims' hostel	Rest the night for 5 gold per member per level: full health, and all prayers, psalms and gifts renewed. With no money you sleep on the floor and wake with prayers renewed and a third of your health.
The Eparch's palace	News, quests and rewards.
The Harbour gate	Passage to the themes for 50 gold, and the road to the ford at Arkadiopolis. Barred until the end of Act I. The captain warns you if your band looks too weak for the road.
The Undercroft	The Crypts of the Emperors and the Drowned Cisterns beneath the City, the heart of Act I.

A few street scenes appear in the City menu as well. They vanish once you have seen them.

> **Tip.** Rest at the hostel before every expedition. Prayers only come back with rest, and you will need them.

CHAPTER 5

Exploring

Each dungeon level is a descent of six to eight stages. The depth bar under the title shows where you are.

Choice	What happens
Press deeper	You move one stage down. Something waiting at that depth happens first. Otherwise you may meet a trap or a random encounter, or the way may be quiet.
A named place	Returns you to something you left unfinished at this depth or above.
Fall back	Moves you one stage up. You can still be attacked on the way.
Stairs, or Leave for the City	At the bottom of a level, stairs lead down to the next. At the top of the first level, you can leave for the City.

The Holds

Each rebel archon keeps a **Hold**: a lair sunk beneath a place of false worship, where its power pools. A Hold is the second level of each theme, and an Idol-born lord waits at the bottom. The City has its own Hold, the Undercroft, beneath the roofless Great Church.

Hold	Theme	Where it lies
The Undercroft	The City	Beneath the Great Church: crypts, drowned cisterns, catacombs, and a bronze gate
The Drowned Mint	Waters	Sea-caves under the Goldhand's harbour
The Garden Below	Gardens	A cavern paradise under the hippodrome of Thessalonike
The Barrow of Gathos	Heights	The dead giant's tomb, cut into Mount Argaeus
The Well of Azazel	Wilderness	A dry well that falls into a buried salt city
The Roots of the Tower	Nebrodia	The foundations of the first Babel

Vigil lamps

The Holds still hold lamp niches, cold for a century. When you find one, you can relight it with a flask of **lamp oil**. The lamp must burn through its first night, and the Blight sends horrors against it. Hold the niche until dawn and the lamp is lit for good. Carry lamp oil into every Hold.

- **The lamp road.** From then on, you can walk straight down to the lamp from the top of the level without a fight.
- **Rest.** Once each visit, a night beside the lamp heals half your health and gives each member back two uses of grace.

The Blight

Rebel rule sickens the land, and the deeper a theme bows, the more the Blight shows. Each theme's Blight takes the shape of its idol: coins growing on ship hulls in the Waters, flowers with teeth in the Gardens, swords sprouting in the fields of the Heights, singing sand and salt pilgrims in the Wilderness. The Blight lifts when a theme is Returned.

Light

Most dungeons are dark. Each stage you move uses up light. In the dark you meet more traps and more foes, so keep a light burning.

Source	Stages of light
Torch	4
Lamp oil	15
Phos hilaron (psalm)	12
Lamp of icon (prayer)	20
Lamp of Saint Mamas (relic)	15, relit after every rest

Dangers on the way

- **Traps** hit about half the party with darts and may poison them. An Akrites often spots them first, and the Discernment prayer avoids the next three.
- **Poison** costs 2 hit points each stage you move, but never kills on its own. Cure it with myrrh, healing hands, the Cleansing prayer or the Great Church.
- **Random encounters** come in one to three groups of foes.

Helpful prayers while exploring

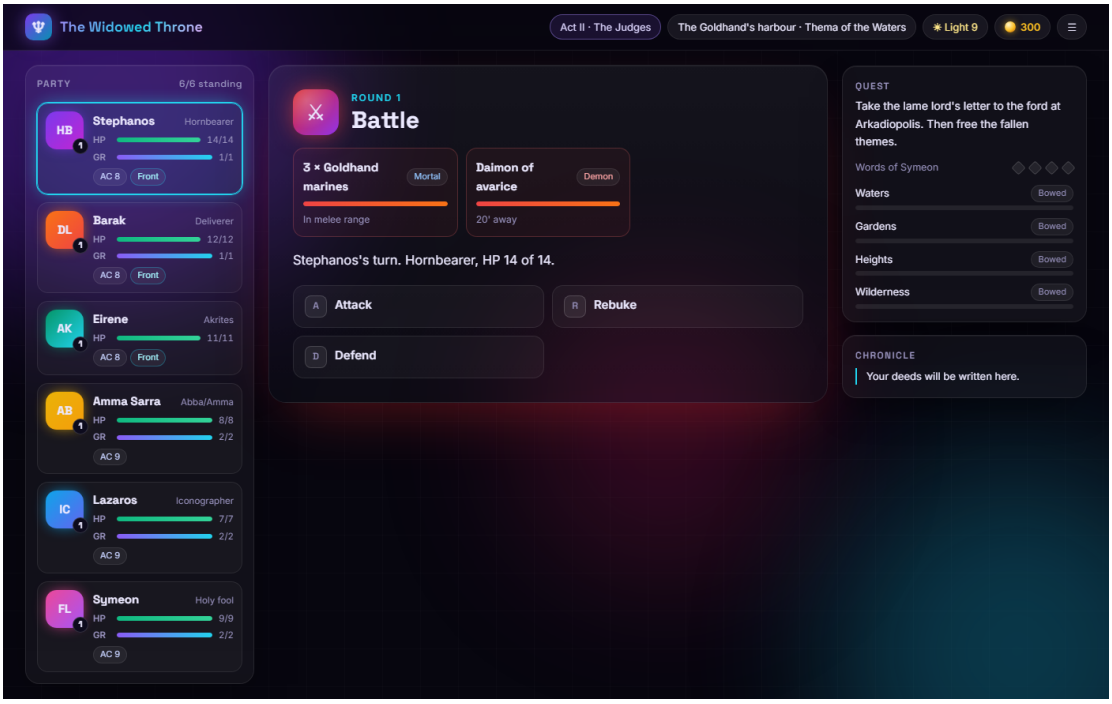
- **Map of the way** shows what waits at each depth of the level.
- **Parting sea** makes your next step deeper safe from traps and encounters.
- **Way home** returns the whole party to the City at once.

> **Tip.** When your healers are nearly out of prayers, go back up and rest. Bosses wait at the bottom of each theme, and they are much harder than anything on the way down.

CHAPTER 6

Combat

Foes come in groups, each at a distance: 10 feet is melee range. Groups farther away walk 10 feet closer each round, and some attack from range.



A battle. Enemy groups are shown as cards with their health. The member whose turn it is glows in the party column.

Each round you choose **Fight** or **Run**. When you fight, you give an order to each member in turn, and then the round plays out in order of initiative.

Order	Who	Effect
Attack	Front three only	Strike a group in melee range.
Fire	Anyone with a sling or bow	Shoot a group up to 40 feet away.
Pray	Abba/Amma, Iconographer	Use a battle prayer.
Sing a psalm	Holy fool	A psalm that lasts the whole fight.
Healing hands	Anargyros	Heal one member and cure poison.
Rebuke	Hornbearer	Cast demons and shades out of a group.
Spirit of might	Deliverer, front rank	Three hard blows in one round.
Use item	Anyone	Holy water (thrown up to 30 feet), bread and wine, myrrh.
Defend	Anyone	Act first and take AC -2 this round.
Cry out to God	Anyone, when things are desperate	Once per dungeon level, when half the party is down or badly hurt, or in a boss fight.

Hitting and armour class

Armour class counts down from 10: lower is better, and very good armour shows as LO. An attack hits when a d20 roll plus the attacker's bonus plus the target's armour class reaches 20. A natural 20 always hits and a natural 1 always misses.

Special rules

- **Only the first three can fight hand to hand**, and foes in melee attack only them. Put your armoured fighters in front with **Order party**.
- **Giants fall to small things.** Humble weapons (club, sling, goad, tent peg, bare hands) do double damage to giants, and sometimes fell one outright.
- **Spirits.** Demons and shades take only half damage from weapons that are not blessed. Prayers, holy water and blessed weapons work in full.
- **Running** works about half the time, better with good luck. You cannot run from a boss.
- **Crying out** may bring a stranger who holds your foes back and heals the party. The answer may also be *wait*, or a different gift.
- **Winning** shares the experience among the living and adds the gold to your purse. Now and then you find supplies.
- **The fallen** can be raised at the Great Church or with the Talitha koum prayer. If the whole party falls, load your last save.

The lords of the Holds

The Idol-born and the other great lords fight in **phases**. When one form breaks, the next begins, often with new servants, and you cannot rest in between. Some of them talk before they fight, and some offers they make are real.

Every lord has a weakness that a band who pays attention can use. Listen to survivors, saints and old stories along the way, and look for the choice before the fight begins.

When the last form of an Idol-born breaks, the human face surfaces for a moment and pleads. You can **offer Christ's mercy**. It works more often when a holy fool or an elder of the Desert is with you, when you have met the Lion, and when none of you holds a foothold. A lord who repents lives, human and free, and the story remembers it.

What foes can do

Ability	Effect	Protection
Poison	Poisons on a hit.	Cure it afterwards.
Accusation	A member with footholds loses their next action.	Helmet of Salvation or Belt of Truth.
Charm	A member stands dreaming instead of acting.	Holy fool, Belt of Truth, Veil of the Myrrh-bearer.
Fear	Members may tremble and lose the round.	Boots of Peace, holy fool.
Breath, sorcery	Damage to the front rank or the whole party.	Shield of Faithfulness halves it. The Seal prayer stops sorcery.
Despair	A prayer or psalm dies on the lips.	Boots of Peace.

CHAPTER 7

Prayer and psalms

Heroes in this world pray; they do not cast spells. The Abba or Amma and the Iconographer each receive a number of prayers per rest in five circles. A new circle opens at levels 1, 3, 5, 7 and 9, and each circle gains more prayers as you rise. Rest at the hostel to renew them.

Most prayers are answered. Sometimes the answer is **wait**: nothing happens, but the prayer is not spent.

Prayers of the Abba and Amma

Circle	Prayer	When	Effect
1	Kyrie	Any time	Heal one: 2d6 + level.
1	Shield of faith	Battle	Party AC -2 this fight.
2	Rebuke	Battle	Casts out spirits: 3d6 + level to demons and shades.
2	Cleansing	Any time	Cure poison, fear and charm.
3	Bind wounds	Any time	Heal all: 2d8.
3	Bind strong man	Battle	A group loses two rounds. Giants resist.
4	Talitha koum	Exploring	Raise the dead to 1 hit point.
4	Fire of Elijah	Battle	5d8 fire to a group.
5	Trisagion	Battle	6d8 to all spirits, 2d8 to all others.
5	Make whole	Any time	Full heal and cure for all living.

Prayers of the Iconographer

Circle	Prayer	When	Effect
1	Lamp of icon	Exploring	Light for 200 steps.
1	Discernment	Any time	Reveal secret doors nearby. Unmask deceivers.
2	Map of the way	Exploring	Show the whole level.
2	Ward	Any time	Party AC -2 until the next rest.
3	Seal	Battle	A group hits at -4 and cannot work sorcery.
3	Parting sea	Exploring	Walk through the wall ahead.
4	Altar coal	Battle	4d8 + level to a group.
4	Way home	Exploring	Return to the City.
5	Pantocrator	Battle	Every foe may be struck blind; 3d8 to spirits.

Psalms of the holy fool

Level	Psalm	Effect
1	Kyrie eleison	Party AC -2 for the fight, or until the next fight.
1	Phos hilaron	Gladsome light: light for 120 steps.
3	Trisagion	Demons and shades strike at -3 this fight.
5	Psalm 23	The Shepherd: each round the party heals 1d4.
7	Song of ascent	Party strikes at +2 this fight.
9	Fool's truth	Men who hear it may throw down their arms.

Outside battle a fool can sing Kyrie eleison (the party is guarded until the next fight), Phos hilaron (light), and from level 5 Psalm 23 (the whole party heals a little).

CHAPTER 8

The spiritual war

Swords do not reach the rebel powers that rule the themes. What loosens their grip is people turning their allegiance back to God.

Allegiance

Each theme moves along a track: **Bowed**, **Contested**, **Wavering** and **Returned**. The quest tracker shows where each one stands. Public acts that the people see move a theme along, such as:

- **Free its captives.**
- **Break its idol.** This is also where you find each Word of Symeon.
- **Fill the empty house.** After the idol falls, pay 500 gold to leave faith, justice and care in its place: a chapel, an orphanage, a garrison or a well.

A theme that reaches Returned casts out its archon, and the Blight lifts. The Gospel warns that a house swept clean and left empty invites seven worse spirits, and the game keeps that rule. Every theme you return weakens the final enemy, and every house you leave empty sends unclean spirits to stand with him.

Allegiance	What the land looks like
Bowed	A red sun behind haze. The dead walk, and Sheol seeps through cracks in the ground.
Contested	The sky bruises at dusk, stone faces push out of the walls, and wells run brackish.
Wavering	Cold spots in the houses, milk that sours on feast days, and shared nightmares.
Returned	Lamps burn in the chapels, birds nest in the eaves, and the dead rest.

Temptation and footholds

Now and then the game offers you something good for nothing: treasure, a feast, a famous sword, a crown. Taking it pays off at once, and it also gives the Adversary a **foothold** in every member of the party except a holy fool. There are four kinds: Gold, Flesh, Sword and Crown.

Footholds cause	
Demons	Strike at +1 per foothold on their target, up to +3.
Accusers	Can freeze a member with footholds for a round.
The armour of God	A piece goes cold, giving no protection, while its wearer holds a foothold of the matching kind.
Thresholds	A cherub bars the way to anyone who holds three footholds or more.

To clear footholds, make **Confession** at the Great Church. Gold footholds need restitution of 150 gold each before they clear.

The Lion of Judah

No roll, prayer or relic can call the Lion. He comes when he chooses, at the turning points of the story, and he speaks little. A band that meets him is changed: every foothold is confessed and gone, every wound and every prayer is restored, and each member rises with more faith. He does not fight your battles for you. He sends you back into them.

The armour of God

The Tagma blessed each piece of a knight's harness with a virtue from Paul's letter to the Ephesians. One piece waits in each region you visit. They go to whoever needs them most, and anyone can wear them.

Piece	Protection	Goes cold with
Belt of Truth	AC -1. Guards against accusation and charm.	Crown
Breastplate of Justice	AC -6.	Gold
Shield of Faithfulness	AC -3. Halves fire, breath and sorcery.	Flesh
Boots of Peace	AC -1. Guards against fear and despair.	Sword
Helmet of Salvation	AC -2. Guards against accusation.	Never
Sword of the Word	Damage 3d6+2, blessed, +6 against spirits.	Never

CHAPTER 9

Equipment

The Mese sells everything below. Weapons and armour you buy are put on at once, and the old item goes into the pack.

Weapons

Weapon	Damage	Notes	Gold
Club	1d4	humble	5
Dagger	1d4	-	20
Staff	1d6	-	15
Steel mace	1d6+1	-	60
Spathion	1d8+1	-	150
Axe	1d8	-	120
Kontarion	1d10+1	Hornbearer only	300
Sling	1d4	humble, ranged	10
Bow	1d6+1	ranged	200
Goad	1d4+1	humble	25

Armour

Armour	AC	Gold
Quilted coat	-1	40
Mail shirt	-3	250
Lamellar	-5	900
Shield	-1	60
Kite shield	-2	200
Helm	-1	80

The kite shield is for Hornbearers and Deliverers. See the callings table for who may wear what.

Supplies

Item	Use	Gold
Torch	Light for 4 stages.	5
Lamp oil	Light for 15 stages.	40
Holy water	Throw at a group: 2d8+2 to each spirit, 1d4 to others.	60
Bread and wine	Heals 2d6.	30
Myrrh	Cures poison.	50

Relics

The Holds hide what the rebels stole: relics of saints and arms of the warrior saints. Relics cannot be sold. Some of the ones you may find:

Relic	Power
Sling of Poimen	Damage 2d6+2, humble and blessed, +2 more to giants.
Lance-head of Theodore	Damage 1d10+2, blessed, +4 to serpents and dragons.
Veil of the Myrrh-bearer	Worn as a helm, AC -1. The wearer cannot be charmed.
Lamp of Saint Mamas	Light for 15 stages, relit after every rest.

Some treasures of the Holds were touched by the idols. They are powerful, and taking them costs a foothold.

> **Tip.** Give everyone who can use one a sling. Slings are cheap, reach from the back rank, and do double damage to giants.

CHAPTER 10

Bestiary

Six kinds of foe walk the themes. **Demons** and **shades** are spirits: unblessed weapons do half damage to them, and they are cast out rather than killed. **Giants** are flesh and fall to small things. **Mortals**, **beasts** and **serpents** are ordinary foes.

Many of the minions of the Holds began as victims: masked revellers, branded soldiers, drowned debtors, pilgrims turned to salt, labourers who forgot their names. Beaten, many of them fall as people again, dazed and alive.

The lords of the Holds, and whatever waits deepest in the Undercroft, are left for you to meet.

The City and the Undercroft

Foe	Kind	Armour	Abilities
Cutpurse	Mortal	8	-
Mocker	Mortal	7	-
Cistern rat	Beast	9	-
Restless heir	Shade	7	-
Cistern serpent	Serpent	7	poison
Scribe of the Tower	Mortal	8	accusation
Daimon of avarice	Demon	6	accusation
Rephaim shade	Shade	5	-

The Waters

Foe	Kind	Armour	Abilities
Fog pirate	Mortal	7	-
Goldhand marine	Mortal	5	-
Coin-wight	Shade	7	-
Brood of Rahab	Serpent	4	-
Drowned shade	Shade	5	-

The Gardens

Foe	Kind	Armour	Abilities
Reveler	Mortal	8	charmed by the festival
Festival mask	Mortal	7	charm
Priestess	Mortal	6	charm
Daimon of desire	Demon	4	charm
Orchard serpent	Serpent	5	poison

The Heights

Foe	Kind	Armour	Abilities
Bandit	Mortal	5	-
Iron-branded	Mortal	3	-
Giant-blooded brute	Giant	4	-
Gibbor	Giant	3	-
Rephaim	Shade	3	-

The Wilderness

Foe	Kind	Armour	Abilities
Raider	Mortal	5	-
Salt pilgrim	Shade	6	-
Goat-demon	Demon	3	-
Fiery serpent	Serpent	3	poison, fire
Noonday demon	Demon	2	despair

Nebrodia

Foe	Kind	Armour	Abilities
Concord soldier	Mortal	2	-
Brick-mute	Mortal	5	-
Nephilim seer	Giant	2	sorcery
Anakim	Giant	0	-

CHAPTER 11

Counsel from the Abba

Some advice for your first chronicle, without spoiling the story.

Suggested order

Region	Suggested party level
The Undercroft (upper)	1 to 3
The Waters	3 and up
The Gardens	4 and up
The Heights	5 and up
The Wilderness	6 and up
Nebrodia	8 and up

- Visit Abba Pelagios after every expedition. Levels do not rise on their own.
- Keep your fighters in the first three places and your healers behind them.
- Rest before you descend to the last stage of a level. The worst fight is waiting there.
- Save up 500 gold before you break an idol, so you can fill the empty house at once.
- Think twice before accepting anything offered for free.
- Carry lamp oil into every Hold, and light the vigil lamp when you find it.
- When a lord's human face pleads, remember the Zacchaeus in every story.
- A holy fool sees through flattery and cannot be tempted. Take one along.
- If a character is killed, the Great Church can raise them. It is cheaper early on.
- Each Word of Symeon is part of a single message. Read them together.

"Whom will the Horn anoint?"

The founder's question, asked by every Hornbearer at every holy place.